Structured Cabling Project
Project Summary

While working on this project with my partner, the main key factor that influenced our design was to individually learn how to complete this project using the tools introduced to us since we were both unfamiliar with them. Our goal was to hit every objective that was given by the project description while learning how to use Microsoft Visio and Excel. Another key factor was that there were no cost and design restraints, so we just went with what was simplest in our opinion. We worked on one floor of the design each as well as created and calculated our own floor's cables and costs in the same Visio and Excel workspace.

I gave myself the responsibility of creating the Visio and Excel workspaces to share with my partner so that we were able to learn together and see each other's work if any questions or concerns were to arise. This allowed us to work in real time together and learn from each other's work. I learned that I was able to comment on a piece of information that my partner worked on in Excel and it pinged him right away to let him know my concerns. I found it very useful when one person is not in the workspace and you are able to let them know exactly what and where your question pertains to so they can get to it later.

The main challenge for me while working on this project was learning Microsoft Visio. I had a tough time drawing shapes and lines and trying to get them to fit into each other and look descent. I would try to draw lines to divide up a big space to create rooms for our design but found it difficult to make every line the perfect length and straight. During the process I decided to draw a large rectangle depicting the size of our building and then just layering smaller squares and rectangles inside to divide up the space, although this led to some layering issues that I was able to sort out.

Two important lessons that I took away from this project are that it's okay not to be perfect in every little thing that we do, and that cabling and networking a building can cost a lot of money depending on the size of the building and the customer's operating needs. I learned the basics of working in Microsoft Visio and Excel, as well as how to do a basic design and cost estimate for structuring cables in a building.